

Data Upload Template — Instructions

This workbook is the standard template for uploading survey data into the system. It must contain exactly **three sheets**, named exactly as below.

What each sheet means

Sheet	What it contains
data	The raw respondent-level data. One row per respondent, one column per question/variable, with column names in the header row (row 1).
variable_labels	A dictionary describing every column that appears in "data" — its exact name and a human-readable label (the question text or field description).
value_labels	The code-to-answer mapping for coded/categorical columns — what each numeric code in "data" actually means (e.g. 1 = "Yes", 2 = "No"). Columns that are not coded (open text, raw numbers, IDs, timestamps) simply do not appear here.

Columns in "variable_labels"

Column	Meaning
variable	Exact column name as it appears in "data".
variable_label	Human-readable description of that column (typically the question text).

Columns in "value_labels"

Column	Meaning
variable	The column this block of codes belongs to. Only shown on the first row of each block.
code	The raw value stored in "data" for that column.
value_label	The human-readable meaning of that code.

Common question types you'll see

- **Single-choice questions** are stored as a single numeric code per column; the meaning of each code is documented in "value_labels".
- **Multi-select / "select all that apply" questions** are stored as one column per option, each coded 0/1 (e.g. Q2_1, Q2_2, Q2_3 — one column per option).
- **"Other, please specify" fields** pair with a coded question and use an "_other" suffix, holding free text entered only when "Other" is selected.
- **Open-end / verbatim questions** are free text, with no entry in "value_labels".

*For a clearer, hands-on understanding of this structure, check the accompanying **sample_data.xlsx** file — it shows all three sheets filled in with example data.*